

Life is dreamlike, stay neutral and enjoy

William Shakespeare captured the **essence** of the Bhagwad Gita's message when he wrote: "All the world's a stage, and all men and women **merely** players; they have their exits and their entrances..." The Gita **extols** the **virtue** of sakshi bhav – a witness-like attitude. This **objectivity** is the key to **material** success, happiness, and personal growth.

The **opposite** of objectivity **is** being involved, **partisan**, and **biased**. Then, you **view the world through tinted glasses**. You see what your mind wants to see. You look at the world through the filter of your likes and dislikes and get a **distorted** vision. This **skewed** perception **leads to** errors and failure. An objective person has clarity of thought. His perception is sharp. Actions become perfect. The mind is **detached**. And success flows effortlessly.

Cultivate the mindset of an observer. Do not get **entangled**. Stay **impartial** in all circumstances, not partisan. Remain **unbiased** and **unprejudiced**. Be like a **spectator** in a boxing ring. If you jump into the ring, you risk getting beaten by both parties. Be an observer of this **magnificent** universe.

You are an actor in the drama of life. Play your role to the best of your ability – **wholeheartedly, enthusiastically**, perfectly, yet **dispassionately**. When the curtain falls, exit **gracefully**. But you go on stage and want to **assert** your **will**. You rewrite the script and **tamper** with roles. You get totally **knotted up** in a **make-believe** world.

The Gita **illustrates** this through Arjun's **plight**. **Paralysed** by grief and attachment, he refuses to perform his duties. Krishn's opening **remarks** are: "The **wise** do not **grieve** for the living or the dead. All grief **stems from** wrong identification and attachment." **Blaming** external factors – spouse, children, govt, or even the weather – **ensures perpetual misery**. The key lies within, not without.

Adopt a **tongue-in-cheek** perspective on life. Today's **trauma** will be a **distant** memory a year from now. Take a long-term **panoramic** view of things. Consider others' challenges, and yours will **pale** into **insignificance**. Rise to a higher plane and struggles of the lower level will **cease** to affect you. Reach out to others, **stretch** to **accommodate** their interests. **Embrace** the **transcendental**. As your mind expands, you become more mature and happier, unaffected by the ups and downs of life.

Attachment to the body, mind, and intellect **binds** you to unhappiness. They are matter. The world is also matter. Matter influences matter, just like a magnet attracts iron. You are not body, mind, or intellect. You are Spirit. The world does not have the power to affect the Spirit. You appear to be affected because of your unintelligent identification and attachment to them. Remember, you are **Atman**. Remain a sakshi, witness, of everything, uninvolved in life's drama.

You **traverse** three **states** of consciousness – waking, dreaming, and deep sleep. Your true Self lies beyond these, the fourth plane. Live life as if you are re-entering a dream, knowing its **illusory** nature. Embrace it with objectivity, joy, and **light-heartedness**, free from **entanglement** and heartache. Objectivity is the secret of enjoyment. Practise objectivity daily. Observe the world around you: external objects, people, their appearance, emotions, and thoughts. Then, turn inward to your own body, mind and **intellect**.

Vocabulary

1. **Essence** (noun) – Core, Soul, Spirit, Heart, Quintessence सार
2. **Merely** (adverb) – Only, Simply, Just, Solely, Purely केवल
3. **Extol** (verb) – Praise, Celebrate, Laud, Commend, Glorify प्रशंसा करना
4. **Virtue** (noun) – Morality, Goodness, Integrity, Excellence, Righteousness गुण
5. **Objectivity** (noun) – Impartiality, Neutrality, Fairness, Detachment, Balance निष्पक्षता
6. **Material** (adjective) – Physical, Tangible, Worldly, Substantial, Earthly भौतिक
7. **Partisan** (adjective) – Biased, Prejudiced, One-sided, Partial, Sectarian पक्षपातपूर्ण
8. **Biased** (adjective) – Prejudiced, Partial, Unfair, Slanted, Discriminatory पक्षपाती
9. **Look (at something) through rose-coloured glasses** (phrase) – To see something in an overly optimistic or idealistic way.
10. **Distorted** (adjective) – Twisted, Warped, Misrepresented, Altered, Deformed विकृत
11. **Skewed** (adjective) – Biased, Distorted, Slanted, Uneven, Misaligned तिरछी नज़र से देखना
12. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Result in, Cause, Bring about, Produce, Trigger वजह बनना
13. **Detached** (adjective) – Uninvolved, Disconnected, Aloof, Neutral, Objective अलग
14. **Cultivate** (verb) – Develop, Nurture, Foster, Encourage, Promote विकसित करना
15. **Entangled** (adjective) – Involved, Trapped, Ensnared, Knotted, Complicated उलझा हुआ
16. **Impartial** (adjective) – Fair, Neutral, Unbiased, Objective, Just निष्पक्ष
17. **Unbiased** (adjective) – Fair, Impartial, Neutral, Objective, Unprejudiced पक्षपातरहित
18. **Unprejudiced** (adjective) – Fair, Impartial, Neutral, Objective, Open-minded पूर्वाग्रहरहित
19. **Spectator** (noun) – Observer, Onlooker, Viewer, Watcher, Bystander दर्शक
20. **Magnificent** (adjective) – Grand, Splendid, Majestic, Glorious, Impressive शानदार
21. **Wholeheartedly** (adverb) – Enthusiastically, Earnestly, Sincerely, Passionately, Fully पूरे दिल से
22. **Enthusiastically** (adverb) – Eagerly, Zealously, Passionately, Excitedly, Vigorously उत्साहपूर्वक

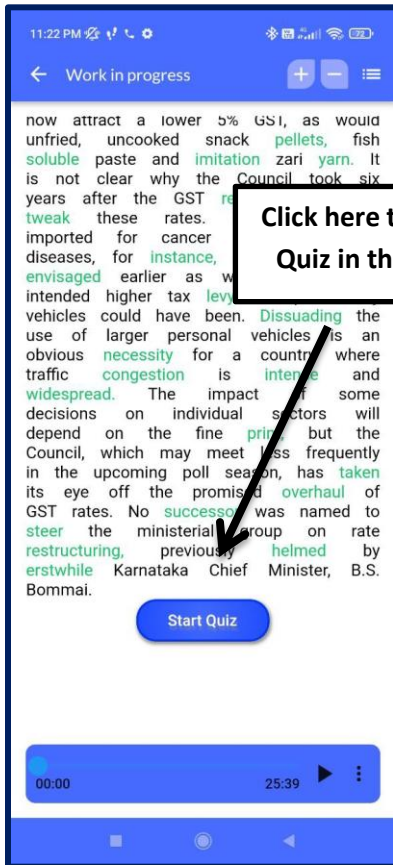
23. **Dispassionately** (adverb) – Calmly, Objectively, Impartially, Neutrally, Rationally निष्पक्ष रूप से
24. **Gracefully** (adverb) – Elegantly, Smoothly, Poisedly, Dignifiedly, Stylishly सहजता से
25. **Assert** (verb) – Declare, Affirm, State, Insist, Maintain दृढ़ता से कहना
26. **Will** (noun) – Desire, Determination, Intention, Resolve, Volition इच्छाशक्ति
27. **Tamper** (verb) – Interfere, Meddle, Tinker, Manipulate, Alter छेड़छाड़ करना
28. **Knot up** (phrasal verb) – Definition: To become tangled or complicated. उलझना
29. **Make-believe** (adjective) – Imaginary, Pretend, Fictional, Unreal, Fantastical काल्पनिक
30. **Illustrate** (verb) – Demonstrate, Explain, Depict, Show, Clarify उदाहरण देना
31. **Plight** (noun) – Difficulty, Predicament, Trouble, Crisis, Dilemma दुर्दशा
32. **Paralyse** (verb) – Immobilize, Disable, Stun, Cripple, Freeze अशक्त करना
33. **Grief** (noun) – Sorrow, Sadness, Anguish, Heartache, Mourning दुःख
34. **Remark** (noun) – Comment, Statement, Observation, Reflection, Utterance टिप्पणी
35. **Wise** (noun) – Sage, Philosopher, Scholar, Thinker, Guru बुद्धिमान
36. **Grieve** (verb) – Mourn, Lament, Sorrow, Weep, Bemoan शोक करना
37. **Stem from** (phrasal verb) – Definition: To originate or arise from something. उत्पन्न होना
38. **Perpetual** (adjective) – Eternal, Continuous, Unending, Constant, Never-ending अनंत
39. **Misery** (noun) – Suffering, Distress, Anguish, Pain, Woe दुःख
40. **Tongue-in-cheek** (adjective) – Definition: Said or done in a humorous or ironic way. मजाकिया
41. **Trauma** (noun) – Shock, Distress, Pain, Suffering, Injury आघात
42. **Distant** (adjective) – Faraway, Remote, Far-off, Removed, Separate दूर
43. **Panoramic** (adjective) – Wide, Broad, Expansive, Sweeping, Comprehensive विस्तृत
44. **Pale** (verb) – Fade, Dim, Dull, Blanch, Lose color फीका पड़ना
45. **Insignificance** (noun) – Unimportance, Triviality, Negligibility, Irrelevance, Pettiness तुच्छता

46. **Cease** (verb) – Stop, Halt, End, Discontinue, Terminate रुकना
47. **Stretch** (verb) – Extend, Expand, Lengthen, Spread, Strain फैलाना
48. **Accommodate** (verb) – Adjust, Adapt, Fit, Assist, Oblige समायोजित करना
49. **Embrace** (verb) – Accept, Adopt, Welcome, Include, Support अपनाना
50. **The Transcendental** (noun) – Spiritual, Divine, Supernatural, Metaphysical, Eternal पारलौकिक
51. **Bind** (verb) – Tie, Restrict, Constrain, Fasten, Attach बांधना
52. **Atman** (noun) – Soul, Spirit, Self, Essence, Inner being आत्मा
53. **Traverse** (verb) – Cross, Travel, Navigate, Pass, Move through पार करना
54. **State** (noun) – Condition, Situation, Phase, Mode, Status अवस्था
55. **Illusory** (adjective) – Unreal, Imaginary, Deceptive, False, Misleading भ्रमपूर्ण
56. **Light-heartedness** (noun) – Cheerfulness, Joy, Carefreeness, Gaiety, Playfulness हल्कापन
57. **Entanglement** (noun) – Complication, Involvement, Snare, Mess, Knot उलझन
58. **Intellect** (noun) – Mind, Intelligence, Reason, Understanding, Wisdom बुद्धि

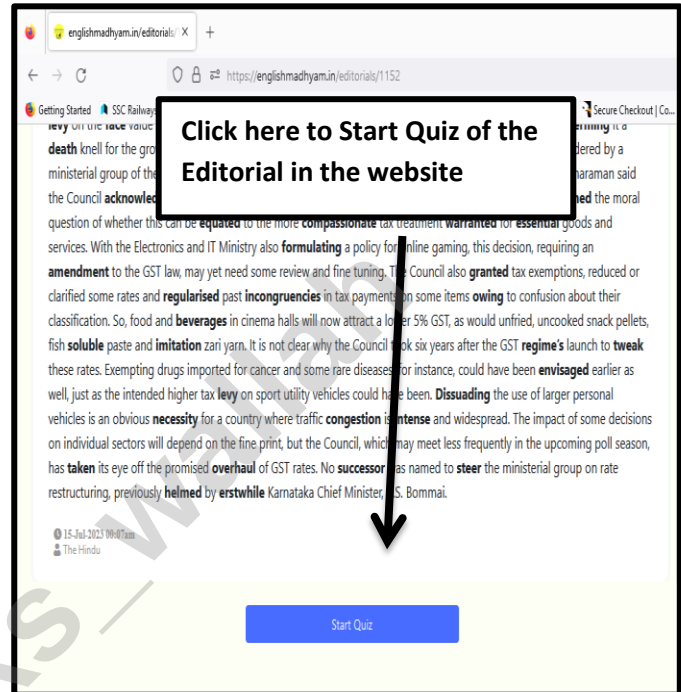
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Dreamlike Nature of Life:** Life is compared to a dream, suggesting a neutral, observant approach to fully enjoy it.
2. **Shakespeare and the Gita:** Shakespeare's "All the world's a stage" aligns with the Bhagavad Gita's concept of *sakshi bhav* (witness-like attitude).
3. **Sakshi Bhav:** Objectivity, as emphasized in the Gita, is key to material success, happiness, and personal growth.
4. **Dangers of Bias:** Being partisan or biased distorts perception, leading to errors and failure.
5. **Clarity Through Detachment:** An objective person has clarity, sharp perception, and perfect actions, leading to effortless success.
6. **Observer Mindset:** Cultivate the mindset of an impartial observer, avoiding entanglement in life's drama.
7. **Role of an Actor:** Play your role in life wholeheartedly but dispassionately, exiting gracefully when the time comes.
8. **Arjun's Plight:** The Gita uses Arjun's grief and attachment to illustrate the dangers of emotional entanglement.
9. **Krishna's Wisdom:** Krishna advises against grieving, emphasizing that grief stems from wrong identification and attachment.
10. **Avoid Blaming External Factors:** Blaming others or external circumstances leads to perpetual misery; the solution lies within.
11. **Tongue-in-Cheek Perspective:** Adopt a light-hearted, long-term view of life's challenges, recognizing their transient nature.
12. **Rise Above Struggles:** By expanding your perspective and helping others, you transcend lower-level struggles.
13. **Spirit vs. Matter:** You are Spirit, not the body, mind, or intellect. The world cannot affect the Spirit unless you identify with matter.
14. **Three States of Consciousness:** Beyond waking, dreaming, and deep sleep lies the true Self, the fourth plane of existence.
15. **Objectivity as Enjoyment:** Practicing objectivity daily allows you to observe the world and yourself with joy, free from entanglement.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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